Data Description

All Data are point feature class stored in json format.
Geographic Coordinate system : World Geodetic System (WGS 1984). EPSG 4326.

All points represent the location of archaeological mega-traps identified on high-resolution satellite imagery. These data were collected for the desert kites study, the most complete inventory of which includes 6721 as of November 1, 2024. Fifteen descriptors detailing various kite elements (Figure 3) were recorded for a sample of 610 kites. Other hunting constructions were discovered during this study; they are more or less related to kites depending on the attributes they share with them (figure 1).

		Attributes		
Kites		Pit-traps (Cells)	Driving lines (Antennae)	Enclosure
Kite-like	V-shaped Kites (Negev and North Arabia)	1 pit-trap	Driving lines	
	Open kites (Arabia)	Pit-traps	Driving lines	
Other constructions	Crescent (Ustyurt)			Enclosure
	Ring (Ustyurt)			Enclosure

Figure 1 : Types of hunting constructions according to their attributes.

Before the hunting function of kites was attested, neutral denominations had been chosen. Although "pit-trap" is now preferable to "cell" and "driving line" is preferable to "antenna", the previous denominations have been retained because they were used in several articles.

Crescents

Location of crescents (Ustyurt plateau).
241 features.
Fields :

- ***ID***: unique identifier
- ***Orient***: geographical orientation of the crescent, from the inside to the outside.

Kites

Location of kites.
6721 features.
Fields :

- ***ID:*** unique identifier. It starts with 2 capital letters which indicate the country (AB = Saudi Arabia, AM = Armenia, IK = Irak, JD = Jordan, KZ = Kazakhstan, LI = Lebanon, SY = Syria, TK = Turkey, UZ = Uzbekistan)
- ***Sample610***: indicates whether the kite belongs to the sample of 610 kites
- ***FieldW***: indicates, where applicable, the nature of the field operations which concerned the kite (none, visit, mapping, excavation)

OpenKites

Location of Open kites (Arabia).
862 features.
Fields (Figure 2)***:***

- ***ID***: unique identifier

- ***Type***: indicates which type the open kite belongs to (V = V-shape; W = W shape; C = irregular shape).
- ***PitTraps***: number of pit-traps
- ***Contig***: indicates whether or not there are contiguous pit traps
- ***Length***: total length of the walls that make up the open kite
- ***Orient***: geographical orientation, from the inside to the outside
- ***SlopeOr***: slope orientation

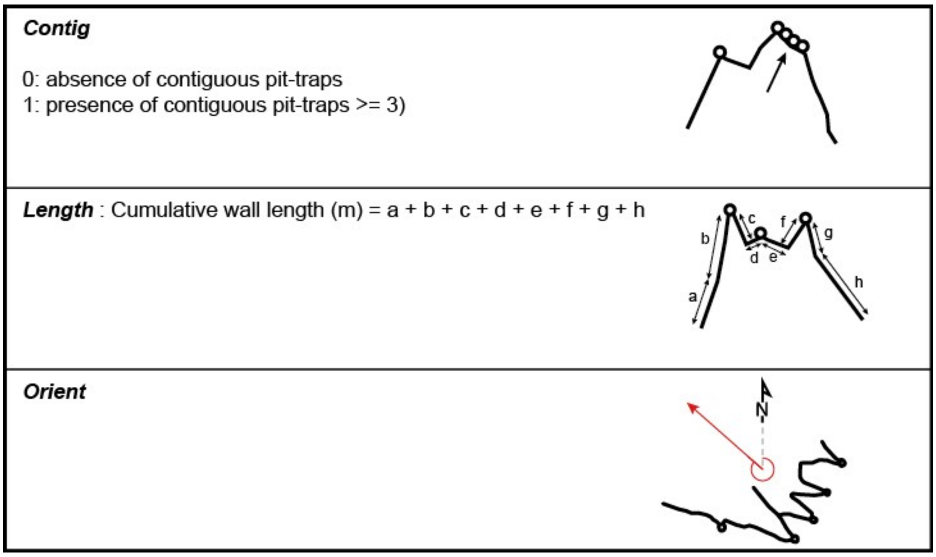

Figure 2: Meaning of values of "Contig", "Length"and "Orient" fields.

Rings

Location of rings (Ustyurt plateau).
62 features.
Fields :

- ***ID***: unique identifier

Sample610

610 features.
Fields (Figure3):

- ***ID***: unique identifier
- ***Elev***: elevation
- ***ANb***: Number of antennae
- ***AML***: Mean length of antennae
- ***ES***: Enclosure surface
- ***ESb***: Subdivisions of the enclosure
- ***ESbP***: subdivision in proximal position
- ***EPI***: Proximal indentation; External outgrowth of the enclosure on either side of the entrance ending in one or more cells
- ***EtW***: Entrance width
- ***EtF***: Funnel entrance; presence of 2 symmetrical walls delimiting the and having a convergent shape towards the interior
- ***EtFA***: Funnel entrance made by antennae; extension of the antenna inside the enclosure forming a funnel
- ***CS***: Number of straight cells
- ***CA***: Number of angle cells

- ***CP***: Number ofpointed cells
- ***CIP***: Number of incipient pointed cells
- ***CC***: Number of contiguous cells

CS + CA + CP + CIP = total number of cells

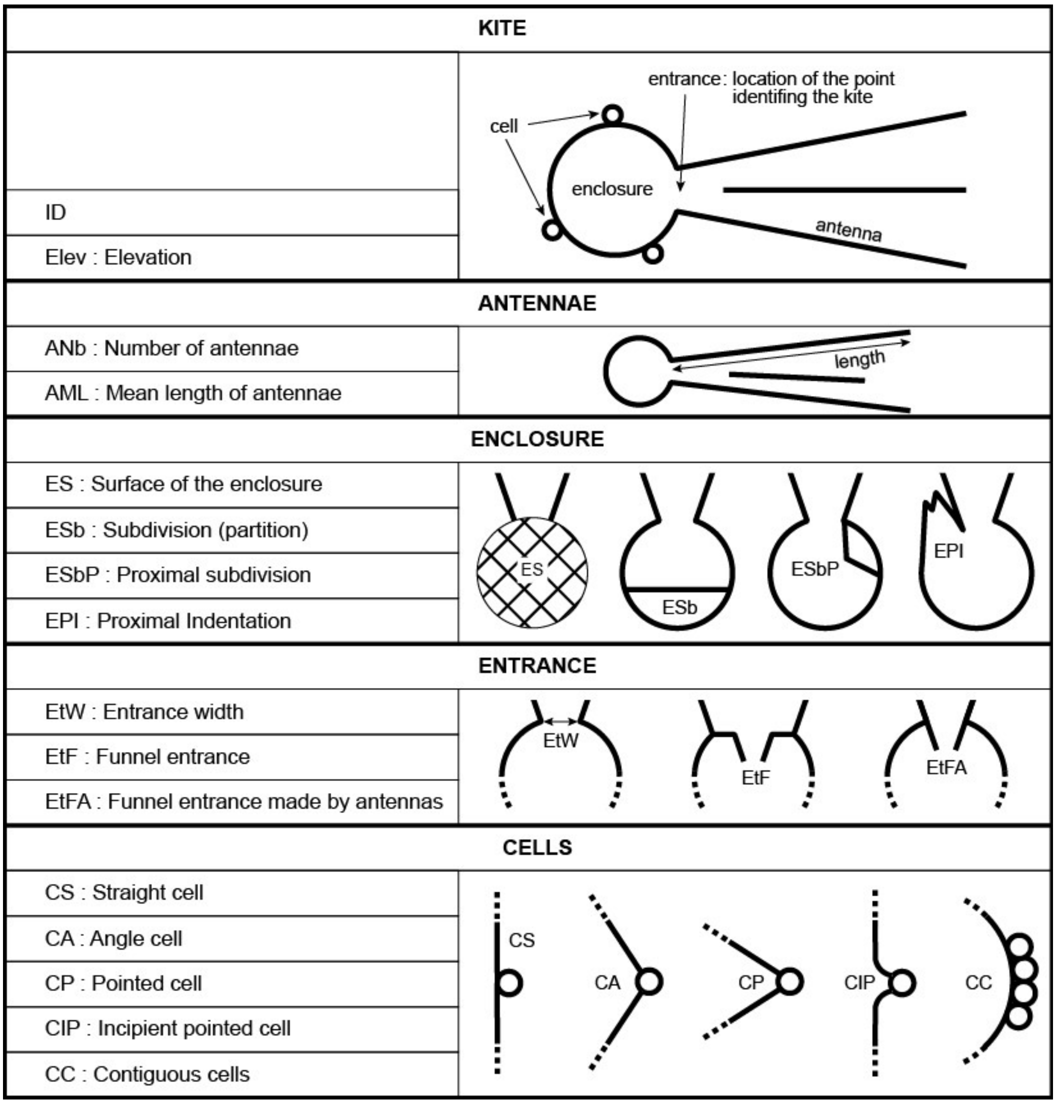

Figure 3: Morphological variables of kites stored in fields

Vshaped

64 features.

Fields :

- ***ID***: unique identifier